

Philipp Hilbert. *Platform product leader who turns infrastructure complexity into developer clarity.*

Positioning, ten years shipping B2B platform products across defence, fintech, and public infrastructure, now ready to define the primitives that power the next generation of Connect platforms.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

Stripe's Connect platform sits at the intersection of two problems I have spent a decade trying to solve: how do you design infrastructure that feels simple to the builder but handles the full complexity of the real world underneath? And how do you make that infrastructure durable enough that it does not need to be rebuilt every time a new business model arrives?

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned a multimodal AI data platform for the FCAS defence programme, a system where dozens of data producers had to conform to one homogeneous training standard without losing the nuance of their source formats. The architectural challenge was identical to what Connect Abstractions faces: define primitives that are restrictive enough to guarantee interoperability but open enough that producers do not have to distort their data to fit. I moved the team away from a UI-heavy approach toward a developer-code-friendly interface and cut rollout time from days to thirty minutes. The lesson was that the right abstraction level removes friction for the sophisticated user while leaving guardrails in place for the less experienced one.

At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a public analytics platform serving labour-market data to journalists, researchers, and policymakers. The challenge there was different, not making infrastructure flexible, but making it legible. A bare-metal-to-container migration ran in parallel with a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration on Dagster and dbt, all shipped without a single data-quality incident visible to public users. What made that possible was defining success metrics before the first sprint and treating the migration as a product problem rather than a purely technical one.

Connect's next challenge, representing AI-native marketplaces and global creator networks, requires exactly this combination. Participants who shift roles, operate across borders, and need new trust mechanisms cannot be shoehorned into account abstractions designed for simpler two-sided marketplaces. The primitives need to be rethought from use cases up, not patched from the top down. I have done that kind of foundational rethinking at two different companies, and I understand both the user pressure that makes it urgent and the engineering discipline required to make the result durable.

I would welcome a conversation about how my background maps to the specific gaps you are solving right now.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
